



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2024 Version B for STA 235H - DATA SCI FOR BUSN APPS: HON (05215) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2024**

Courses Audience: **44**

Responses Received: **44**

Response Ratio: **100%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

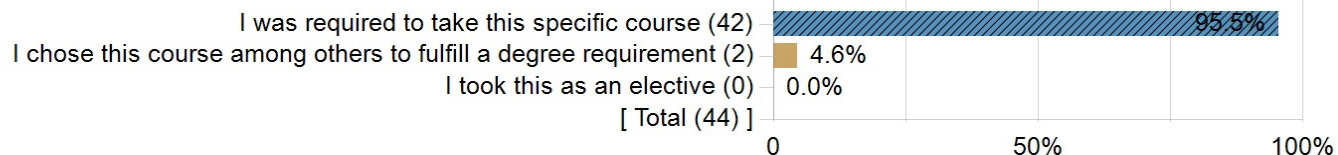
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

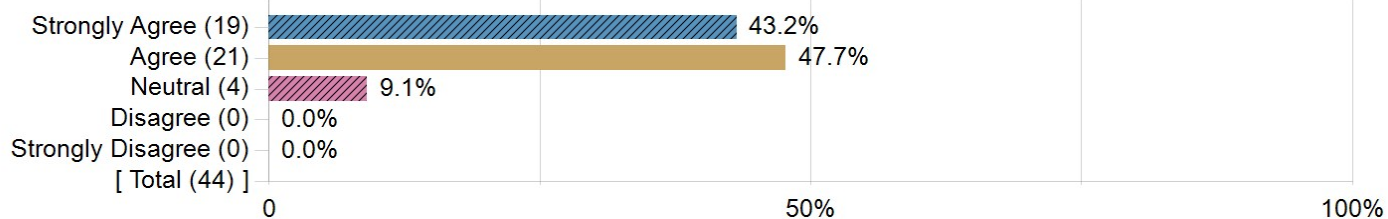
Creation Date: **Thursday, January 23, 2025**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



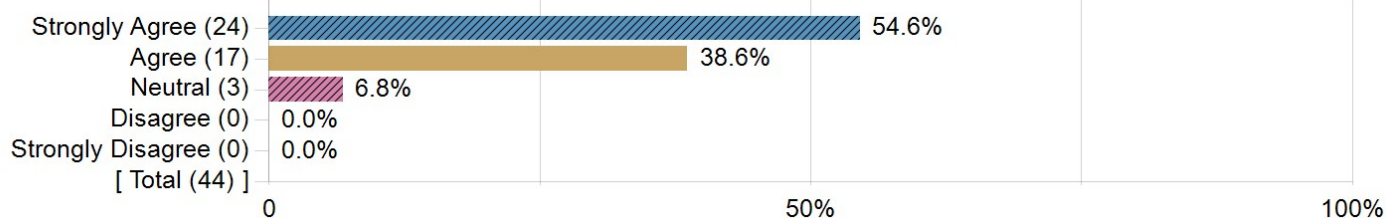
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.34

The course was well organized.



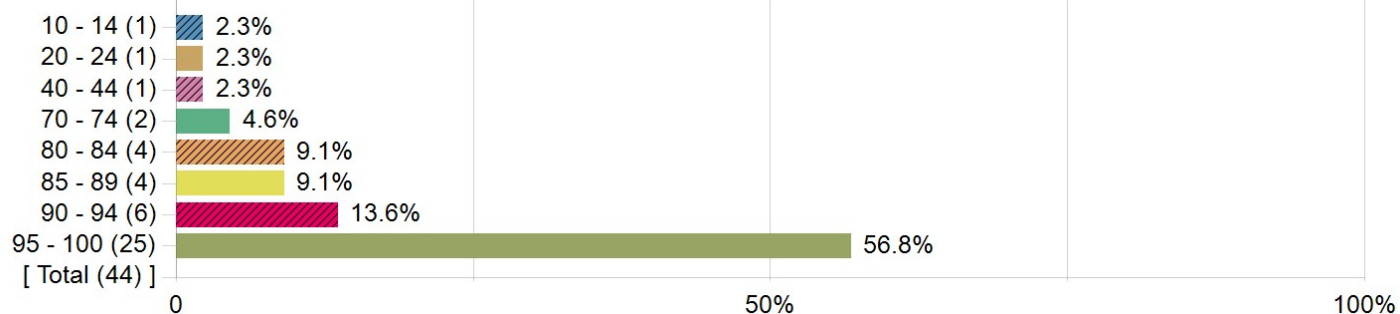
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.48

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



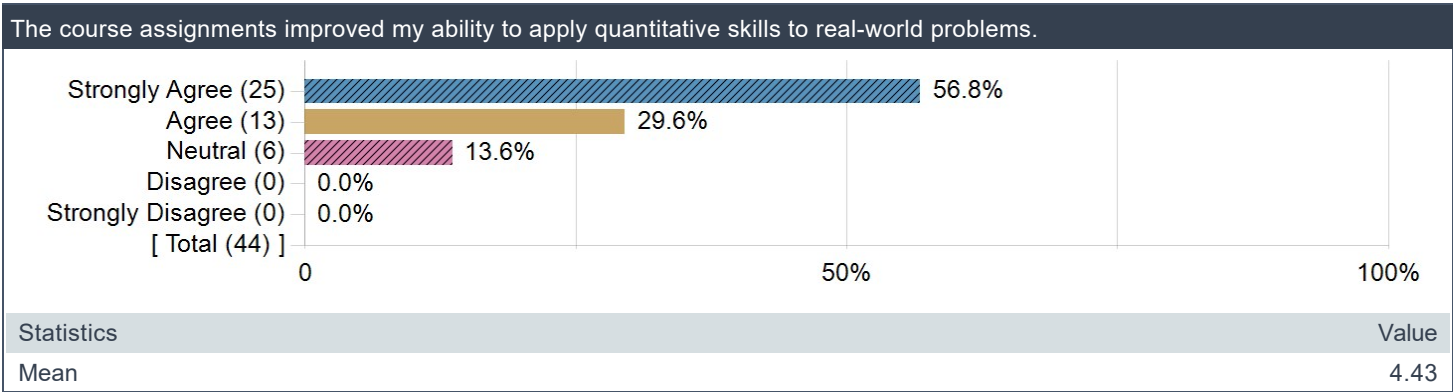
Statistics

Value

Mean

88.45

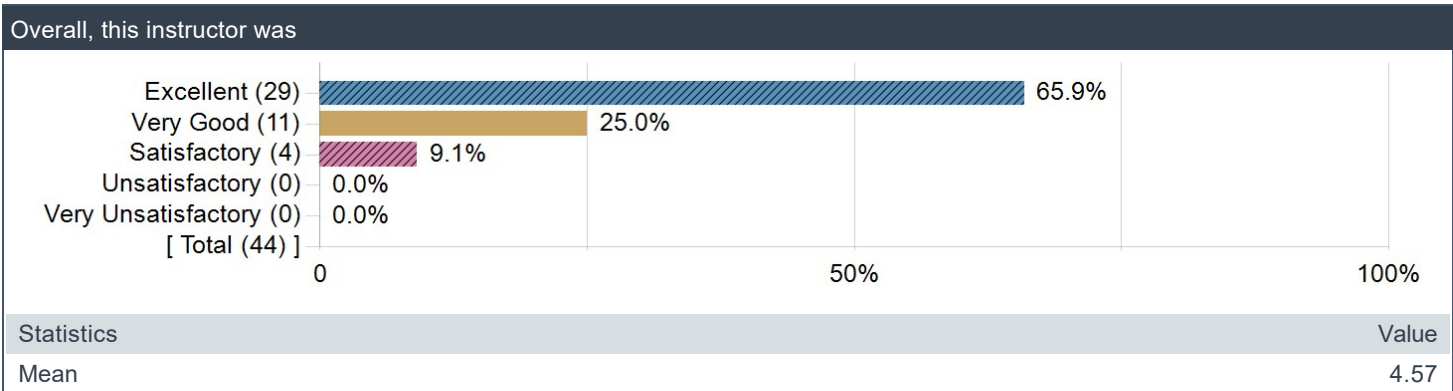
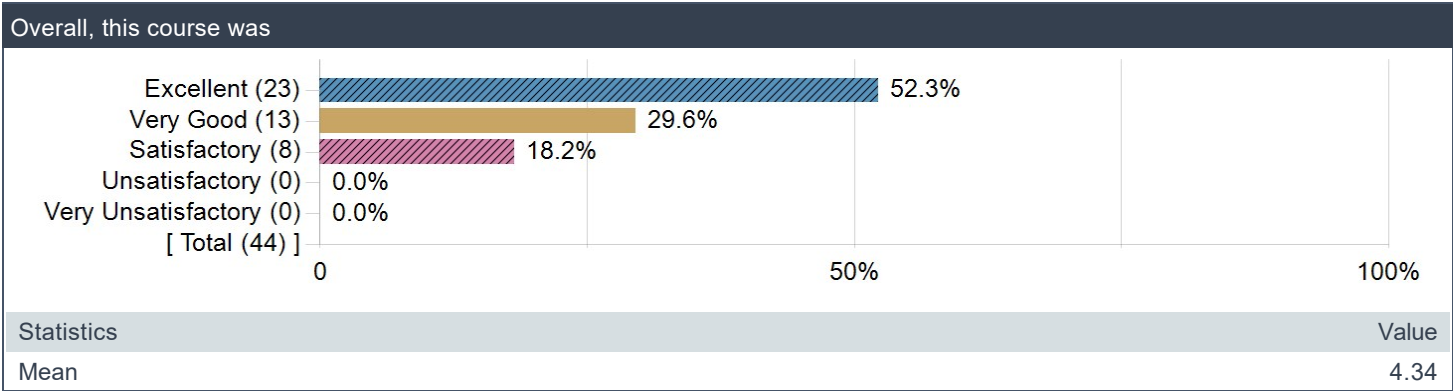
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



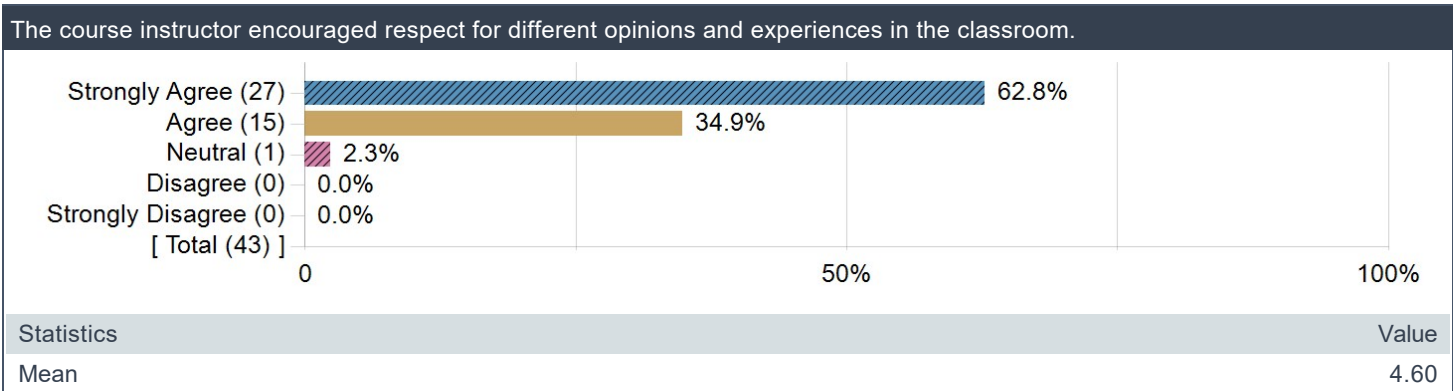
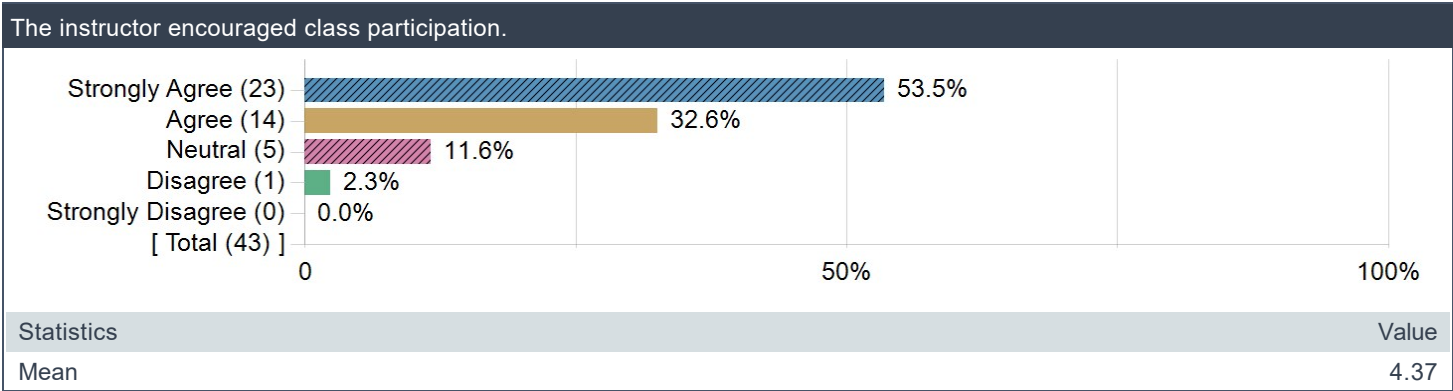
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	65.9%	29.5%	4.5%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.61
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	65.9%	31.8%	2.3%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.64
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	65.9%	25.0%	9.1%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.57
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	52.3%	25.0%	11.4%	9.1%	2.3%	44	4.16
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	65.9%	29.5%	2.3%	2.3%	0.0%	44	4.59

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Having modules from class uploaded and interactive class checks.
I felt like the assignments were fair, and were not busy work. Often, I feel like assignments are extra work than we need to know, so I really appreciate that this class was a good, thoughtful balance between giving enough practice so we learn while not overloading us with work. I also like that this class was structured in the way where anyone that puts effort in should be able to get an A.
I felt like the course material was very well structured in the slides.
great walkthroughs of different models during class with real-world examples
The organization + Giving the code straight up
Lectures
Slides
Live walkthroughs
The classes and homework
Homework assignments
bolfarine gave us multiple attempts on hws and kcs which was really helpful because i got direct feedback and could fix my work which helped me understand r a lot better. he was very kind and understanding and clearly cared about his students and the subject. he was a great teacher.
I found that on the homework, it was helpful to redo problems that we missed. Not only for benefitting our grades but for learning from our mistakes.
The content was really organized.
I thought that the homeworks were very comprehensive in helping me understand the subject matter.
Class examples
The lectures were very well structured, and the powerpoints were very descriptive and helpful to my learning during the lectures. The hw assignments also really helped me understand and reinforce the subject material.
The combination of longer homeworks and shorter weekly assignments really helped me internalize hte information.
Lectures
Homeworks and practice exams
The lectures and the slides were great. I liked the knowledge checks and homeworks too, which were focused on us learning the material rather than being strict on the grade.
Dr Bolafrine is extremely good at explaining hard concepts. Even though there wasn't a textbook for the class, his class and slides really helps you learn the concepts of statistics and teaches you how to apply those concepts for analysis.
The KCs were most effective i helping my learning
Instructor was very helpful and explained the concepts well.
I enjoyed the Canvas page that was in-depth and thorough
I liked the lectures and practices
Nice person very genuine and good teacher
Office hours
the ability to ask and answer questions in class

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
The exams were most challenging because of time constraints.
I found it most challenging to stay on top of materials, which is mostly my fault since it was hard to pay attention throughout the course. One thing that could help future students is making lectures more interactive, such as having more quiz questions scattered throughout each lecture.
At times, the pace of the lectures felt a little slow. However, moving faster could result in an accidental omission of important information, so I understand the slower pace.
homeworks, because there were a lot of questions on them
Sometimes the canvas assignments + questions were formatted weirdly
Homework
Some of the concepts like Time series could have been explained better
Lectures not engaging, lack of textbook. Textbook implementation needed.
Exam
Two hours is a long time to pay attention, more breaks may have been helpful
the course moved a bit fast and had a new topic every week so i'd kinda forget the week before. i think esp for something like log regression having a cheat sheet explaining how to get log odds, odds, and probability would have been nice stuff like that that gets really confusing could be outlined a bit more clearly in somewhere really easy to find. i understood it in clas but then when doing the hws i would get confused again. i also wish we had readings every week because those really helped me study for the test and make my notes but in the second half of the semester we didnt have readings anymore
I found the class time to be the most difficult with going on 2 hours straight. I think the class may be better split into two different sections per week.
The content is hard. I think there could be more practice.
I think that there could have been more interactive elements in class and some of the topics felt a little repetitive and could be bundled together.
Just the r content itself
Not sure, the course was very fair and not particularly difficult since I paid attention in class and understood the material.
I found the most challenging aspect to be the exams, and I'd suggest slightly more available review resources so that students can more easily prepare for the exam.
I thought the course was too focused on coding in R rather than statistic concepts. I found myself using R functions without really understanding what I was doing.
N/A
learning how to use all the functions for each concept
It was challenging to remember some of the lectures so having more readings / lecture recordings would have been AMAZING!
I personally didn't find any concepts particularly challenging. I did think that some of the R code was difficult if I didn't remember it from class. Hopefully for future students there would be a guideline for R codes but otherwise, I would do the homework a little ahead of time so that if you do have trouble not just with the R coding but any general problem to talk to Dr Bolfarine in class or in office hours.
I found the homework to be challenging. I wish there was a guide to help us when completing them.
The content was challenging and the instructor could spend some more time on certain topics.
I think the material is not applicable as other business classes, so focusing may have been difficult.
I found the exams the most challenging
maybe more answer walkthroughs on KC's
All material being condensed into 2 hours a week, hard to keep up with lectures
the exam – questions were unclear at times.